Medical Terminology | Lecture 3

Complete structured study tables: suffixes, prefixes, word roots and every transcribed lecture example. No original slide images are included.
Source: More examples of Suffixes & Prefixes (36-slide lecture). Terms are kept in English. Root explanations are supplementary word-analysis aids, not a verbatim root list from the slides. Original slide spelling may vary.

Study map / concept chart

Word part	What it tells you	Study sequence
ROOT	Core organ, structure or concept	Identify the root
PREFIX	Position, number, direction, state	Check the beginning
SUFFIX	Condition, procedure, specialty, instrument	Check the ending

Surgical suffixes (slides 4-6)

Suffix	Meaning (English)	ALL examples from lecture list
-centesis	Surgical puncture	Pleurocentesis, Pericardiocentesis, Amniocentesis, Arthrocentesis
-clasis	Surgical breaking	Osteoclasis
-desis	Surgical fixation / binding	Arthrodesis
-ectomy	Surgical removal	Tonsillectomy, Mastectomy, Gastrectomy, Appendectomy
-lysis	Breakdown / destruction	Thrombolysis
-pexy	Surgical fixation	Mastopexy, Hysteropexy, Nephropexy, Splenopexy
-plasty	Surgical repair / reconstruction	Rhinoplasty, Mastoplasty, Dermatoplasty
-rrhaphy	Surgical suturing	Myorrhaphy, Rhinorrhaphy, Colorrhaphy
-stomy	Creation of an opening	Tracheostomy, Nephrostomy, Colostomy, Jejunostomy
-tome	Cutting instrument	Osteotome, Dermatome
-tomy	Incision / cutting into	Tracheotomy, Colotomy
-tripsy	Crushing	Lithotripsy, Neurotripsy

Recording, measuring and viewing (slides 7-8)

Suffix	Meaning (English)	ALL examples from lecture list
-gram	Record / picture	Electrocardiogram, Electroencephalogram (EEG)
-graph	Recording instrument	Cardiograph
-graphy	Process of recording / imaging	Angiography, Radiography
-meter	Measuring instrument	Pelvimeter
-metry	Process of measuring	Pelvimetry
-scope	Instrument for viewing	Endoscope, Proctoscope, Otoscope, Fundoscope
-scopy	Visual examination	Endoscopy

Conditions, symptoms and pathology (slides 8-15)

Suffix	Meaning (English)	ALL examples from lecture list
-algia	Pain	Neuralgia, Myalgia
-dynia	Pain	Gastrodynia, Otodynia
-cele	Hernia / protrusion	Hepatocele, Meningocele, Varicocele
-ectasis	Dilation / expansion	Bronchiectasis
-edema	Swelling	Lymphedema
-emesis	Vomiting	Hyperemesis, Hematemesis
-emia	Blood condition	Anemia
-gen	Producing / forming	Carcinogen, Antigen
-genesis	Formation / origin	Carcinogenesis, Embryogenesis
-iasis	Abnormal condition / presence	Cholelithiasis
-itis	Inflammation	Gastritis, Tonsillitis, Otitis, Hepatitis, Arthritis, Gastroenteritis, Osteoarthritis, Encephalomeningitis
-lith	Stone	Cholelith, Fecalith
-malacia	Softening	Chondromalacia, Encephalomalacia
-megaly	Enlargement	Cardiomegaly
-oma	Tumor / mass	Neuroma, Lipoma, Adenoma
-osis	Abnormal condition	Cyanosis
-pathy	Disease	Myopathy, Neuropathy
-penia	Deficiency / decrease	Erythropenia, Thrombocytopenia
-phasia	Speech	Aphasia, Dysphasia
-phobia	Fear	Hemophobia, Polyphobia
-plasia	Formation / development	Dysplasia, Hyperplasia, Aplasia
-plasm	Formation / growth	Neoplasm
-plegia	Paralysis	Hemiplegia, Monoplegia, Quadriplegia
-ptosis	Drooping / prolapse	Blepharoptosis, Hysteroptosis
-rrhage / -rrhagia	Excessive bleeding / bursting forth	Hemorrhage, Menorrhagia
-rrhea	Flow / discharge	Diarrhea, Otorrhea, Rhinorrhea
-rrhexis	Rupture	Arteriorrhexis, Angiorrhexis
-sclerosis	Hardening	Arteriosclerosis, Myosclerosis, Scleroderma
-spasm	Involuntary contraction	Blepharospasm
-stenosis	Narrowing	Arterial stenosis
-toxic	Poisonous / harmful	Hepatotoxic, Nephrotoxic, Neurotoxic
-trophy	Development / nourishment	Dystrophy

Adjective suffixes (slides 16-17)

Suffix	Meaning (English)	ALL examples from lecture list
-ac	Pertaining to	Cardiac, Iliac

Suffix	Meaning (English)	ALL examples from lecture list
-al	Pertaining to	Neural, Lacrimal, Duodenal
-ar	Pertaining to	Muscular, Tonsillar, Clavicular
-ary	Pertaining to	Pulmonary, Axillary, Salivary
-eal	Pertaining to	Esophageal, Peritoneal
-ic	Pertaining to	Thoracic, Hypodermic
-ical	Pertaining to	Pathological, Medical, Physiological
-ile	Pertaining to / capable of	Penile, Fertile, Febrile
-ior	Pertaining to (direction)	Posterior
-ous	Pertaining to	Cutaneous, Sebaceous gland
-tic	Pertaining to	Acoustic, Paralytic ileus, Spermatic cord

Noun and diminutive suffixes (slides 18-20)

Suffix	Meaning (English)	ALL examples from lecture list
-asis	Condition / process	Diuresis
-ia	Condition	Pneumonia
-ism	Condition	Hyperthyroidism, Alcoholism, Albinism, Gigantism
-iatry	Medical treatment / specialty	Podiatry, Physiatry, Psychiatry
-ician	Specialist / practitioner	Obstetrician, Geriatrician
-ist	Specialist	Hematologist, Dermatologist, Cardiologist, Nephrologist
-y	Condition / process	Neuropathy
-icle	Small / diminutive	Ventricle
-ole	Small / diminutive	Arteriole, Bronchiole
-ule	Small / diminutive	Venule, Pustule

Position and timing (slides 22-24)

Prefix	Meaning (English)	ALL examples from lecture list
pre-	Before	Prenatal, Preterm, Pre-operation drugs
peri-	Around	Perinatal, Periumbilical
post-	After	Postnatal
epi-	Upon / above	Epigastric
hypo-	Under / below	Hypodermic, Hypogastric
infra-	Below	Infracostal, Infrared waves
sub-	Under	Subnasal, Subcostal nerve
inter-	Between	Intercostal, Interstitial space
pro-	Before / forward	Prognosis, Pro-otic
retro-	Behind / backward	Retroversion, Retroverted uterus, Retroperitoneal

Number, quantity and size (slides 25-27)

Prefix	Meaning (English)	ALL examples from lecture list
bi-	Two	Bilateral
dipl- / diplo-	Double	Diplopia, Diplobacteria
hemi-	Half	Hemiplegia, Hemisection
hyper-	Excessive / above normal	Hypercalcemia, Hypertension, Hyperglycemia
macro-	Large	Macrocyte, Macrocephaly
micro-	Small	Microcyte, Microscope, Microcephaly
mono-	One	Monotherapy, Monoplegia
uni-	One	Uninuclear, Unilateral
multi-	Many	Multigravida, Multipara
poly-	Many / much	Polyphobia, Polyphagia
nulli-	None	Nulligravida
primi-	First	Primigravida
quadri-	Four	Quadriplegia
tri-	Three	Triceps, Trisomy 21

Direction and location (slides 28-30)

Prefix	Meaning (English)	ALL examples from lecture list
ab-	Away from	Abduction
ad-	Toward	Adduction
circum-	Around	Circumrenal, Circumduction
peri-	Around	Periodontal, Periumbilical
dia-	Through	Diarrhea
trans-	Across / through	Transvaginal
ecto-	Outside	Ectogenous
exo-	Outward	Exotropia
extra-	Outside	Extracranial
endo-	Within	Endocrine
intra-	Within	Intramuscular, Intravascular drugs
para-	Beside / near	Paranasal
super-	Above / excessive	Supernumerary nipples, Superior
supra-	Above	Suprarenal, Supraclavicular fossa
ultra-	Beyond	Ultrasonic, Ultraviolet

Other common prefixes (slides 31-35)

Prefix	Meaning (English)	ALL examples from lecture list
a- / an-	Without / absence	Amastia, Aspermia, Afebrile, Areflexia, Aplasia, Anesthesia, Anemia
im-	Not	Immotile, Immature
ar-	Without / absence (variant)	Arrhythmia
ir-	Not	Irregular pulse
in-	Not	Incomplete, Intractable pain
anti-	Against	Antibacterial, Antiviral, Antifungal, Antigen, Antibody
contra-	Against / opposite	Contraception, Contralateral
brady-	Slow	Bradycardia
dys-	Difficult / abnormal	Dystocia, Dysphasia, Dysplasia, Dystrophy
eu-	Normal / good	Eupnea
hetero-	Different	Heterograft, Heterozygous
homo-	Same	Homograft, Homogeneous
homeo-	Similar / resembling	Homeoplasia
mal-	Bad / abnormal	Malnutrition, Malfunction, Malabsorption
pan-	All	Panarthritis, Pancytopenia
pseudo-	False	Pseudocyesis, Pseudopodia, Pseudohypertrophy
syn- / sym-	Together / joined	Syndactylism, Symphysis, Symbiosis
tachy-	Fast	Tachypnea, Tachycardia

Word roots / combining forms — additional decoding reference

Root	Meaning	Example
aden/o	gland	Adenoma
angi/o	vessel (blood or lymph)	Angiography
arteri/o	artery	Arteriosclerosis
arthr/o	joint	Arthritis
blephar/o	eyelid	Blepharospasm
bronch/o	bronchus	Bronchiectasis
cardi/o	heart	Cardiomegaly
carcin/o	cancer	Carcinogenesis
cephal/o	head	Macrocephaly
chondr/o	cartilage	Chondromalacia
chol/e	bile	Cholelithiasis
col/o	colon	Colostomy
cost/o	rib	Intercostal
crani/o	skull	Extracranial
cutane/o	skin	Cutaneous

Root	Meaning	Example
derm/o, dermat/o	skin	Dermatoplasty
duoden/o	duodenum	Duodenal
encephal/o	brain	Encephalomalacia
enter/o	intestine	Gastroenteritis
erythr/o	red	Erythropenia
esophag/o	esophagus	Esophageal
gastr/o	stomach	Gastritis
geriatr/o	old age / elderly care	Geriatrician
hemat/o, hem/o	blood	Hematology; Hematemesis
hepat/o	liver	Hepatitis; Hepatotoxic
hyster/o	uterus	Hysteropexy
ili/o	ilium (pelvic bone)	Iliac
jejun/o	jejunum	Jejunostomy
lacrim/o	tears	Lacrimal
lip/o	fat	Lipoma
lith/o	stone	Lithotripsy
lymph/o	lymph	Lymphedema
mast/o	breast	Mastectomy
mening/o	meninges	Meningocele
metr/o	uterus	Menorrhagia
muscul/o	muscle	Muscular
my/o	muscle	Myalgia; Myopathy
nas/o	nose	Subnasal
nephr/o	kidney	Nephrostomy; Nephrotoxic
neur/o	nerve	Neuralgia; Neurotoxic
oste/o	bone	Osteoarthritis; Osteotome
ot/o	ear	Otitis; Otoscope
peritone/o	peritoneum	Retroperitoneal
pneumon/o	lung	Pneumonia
proct/o	anus and rectum	Proctoscope
pulmon/o	lung	Pulmonary
radi/o	radiation / x-rays	Radiography
ren/o	kidney	Circumrenal
rhin/o	nose	Rhinoplasty; Rhinorrhea
saliv/o	saliva	Salivary
seb/o	sebum (oil)	Sebaceous

Root	Meaning	Example
sperm/o	sperm	Aspermia
splen/o	spleen	Splenopexy
thorac/o	chest	Thoracic
thromb/o	clot	Thrombolysis; Thrombocytopenia
thyroid/o	thyroid gland	Hyperthyroidism
tonsill/o	tonsil	Tonsillectomy
trache/o	trachea	Tracheostomy
umbilic/o	navel	Periumbilical
vascul/o	vessel	Intravascular
ven/o	vein	Venule

MCQ confusion map

Compare	Distinction	Lecture examples
-ectomy / -otomy / -stomy	Removal / incision / created opening	Gastrectomy / Tracheotomy / Colostomy
-gram / -graph / -graphy	Record / instrument / process	Electrocardiogram / Cardiograph / Angiography
-scope / -scopy	Viewing instrument / examination	Endoscope / Endoscopy
-meter / -metry	Measuring instrument / process	Pelvimeter / Pelvimetry
-rrhea / -rrhagia	Discharge / excessive bleeding	Rhinorrhea / Menorrhagia
-ectasis / -stenosis	Dilation / narrowing	Bronchiectasis / Arterial stenosis
-ptosis / -pexy	Drooping / surgical fixation	Blepharoptosis / Nephropexy
ab- / ad-	Away from / toward	Abduction / Adduction
brady- / tachy-	Slow / fast	Bradycardia / Tachycardia
hyper- / hypo-	Excessive / below	Hyperglycemia / Hypodermic
macro- / micro-	Large / small	Macrocephaly / Microcephaly

Full example index (alphabetical, no slide images)

Examples	Examples	Examples
Abduction	Acoustic	Adduction
Adenoma	Afebrile	Albinism
Alcoholism	Amastia	Amniocentesis
Anemia	Anesthesia	Angiography
Angiorrhexis	Antibacterial	Antibody
Antifungal	Antigen	Antiviral
Aphasia	Aplasia	Appendectomy
Areflexia	Arrhythmia	Arterial stenosis
Arteriole	Arteriorrhexis	Arteriosclerosis

Examples	Examples	Examples
Arthritis	Arthrocentesis	Arthrodesis
Aspermia	Axillary	Bilateral
Blepharoptosis	Blepharospasm	Bradycardia

Examples	Examples	Examples
Bronchiectasis	Bronchiole	Carcinogen
Carcinogenesis	Cardiac	Cardiograph
Cardiologist	Cardiomegaly	Cholelith
Cholelithiasis	Chondromalacia	Circumduction
Circumrenal	Clavicular	Colorrhaphy
Colostomy	Colotomy	Contraception
Contralateral	Cutaneous	Cyanosis
Dermatologist	Dermatome	Dermatoplasty
Diarrhea	Diplobacteria	Diplopia
Diuresis	Duodenal	Dysphasia
Dysplasia	Dystocia	Dystrophy
Ectogenous	Electrocardiogram	Electroencephalogram (EEG)

Examples	Examples	Examples
Embryogenesis	Encephalomalacia	Encephalomeningitis
Endocrine	Endoscope	Endoscopy
Epigastric	Erythropenia	Esophageal
Eupnea	Exotropia	Extracranial
Febrile	Fecalith	Fertile
Fundoscope	Gastrectomy	Gastritis
Gastrodynia	Gastroenteritis	Geriatrician
Gigantism	Hematemesis	Hematologist
Hemiplegia	Hemisection	Hemophobia
Hemorrhage	Hepatitis	Hepatocele
Hepatotoxic	Heterograft	Heterozygous
Homeoplasia	Homogeneous	Homograft

Examples	Examples	Examples
Hypercalcemia	Hyperemesis	Hyperglycemia
Hyperplasia	Hypertension	Hyperthyroidism
Hypodermic	Hypogastric	Hysteropexy
Hysteroptosis	Iliac	Immature
Immotile	Incomplete	Infracostal

Examples	Examples	Examples
Infrared waves	Intercostal	Interstitial space
Intractable pain	Intramuscular	Intravascular drugs
Irregular pulse	Jejunostomy	Lacrimal
Lipoma	Lithotripsy	Lymphedema
Macrocephaly	Macrocyte	Malabsorption
Malfunction	Malnutrition	Mastectomy
Mastopexy	Mastoplasty	Medical

Examples	Examples	Examples
Meningocele	Menorrhagia	Microcephaly
Microcyte	Microscope	Monoplegia
Monotherapy	Multigravida	Multipara
Muscular	Myalgia	Myopathy
Myorrhaphy	Myosclerosis	Neoplasm
Nephrologist	Nephropexy	Nephrostomy
Nephrotoxic	Neural	Neuralgia
Neuroma	Neuropathy	Neurotoxic
Neurotripsy	Nulligravida	Obstetrician
Osteoarthritis	Osteoclasis	Osteotome
Otitis	Otodynia	Otorrhea
Otoscope	Panarthritis	Pancytopenia

Examples	Examples	Examples
Paralytic ileus	Paranasal	Pathological
Pelvimeter	Pelvimetry	Penile
Pericardiocentesis	Perinatal	Periodontal
Peritoneal	Periumbilical	Physiatry
Physiological	Pleurocentesis	Pneumonia
Podiatry	Polyphagia	Polyphobia
Posterior	Postnatal	Pre-operation drugs
Prenatal	Preterm	Primigravida
Pro-otic	Proctoscope	Prognosis
Pseudocyesis	Pseudohypertrophy	Pseudopodia
Psychiatry	Pulmonary	Pustule
Quadriplegia	Radiography	Retroperitoneal

Examples	Examples	Examples
Retroversion	Retroverted uterus	Rhinoplasty

Examples	Examples	Examples
Rhinorrhaphy	Rhinorrhea	Salivary
Scleroderma	Sebaceous gland	Spermatic cord
Splenopexy	Subcostal nerve	Subnasal
Superior	Supernumerary nipples	Supraclavicular fossa
Suprarenal	Symbiosis	Symphysis
Syndactylism	Tachycardia	Tachypnea
Thoracic	Thrombocytopenia	Thrombolysis
Tonsillar	Tonsillectomy	Tonsillitis
Tracheostomy	Tracheotomy	Transvaginal
Triceps	Trisomy 21	Ultrasonic
Ultraviolet	Unilateral	Uninuclear

Examples	Examples	Examples
Varicocele	Ventricle	Venule

Source fidelity note

This reference reorganizes the transcribed lecture terms into tables rather than reproducing the original slides. The source PDF contains image-based tables and figures with limited extractable text; while the transcribed terms and examples are included, a character-by-character audit of every image label has not been established. For high-stakes exam completeness, compare uncertain spellings with the source. Examples include source variants Omniocentesis/Amniocentesis and Angiorrhexix/Angiorrhexis.